Power of Names, Knowledge of Demons

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43772986.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Major Character Death

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Kyle & Lonnie & Rogelio (She-ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Lonnie (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Adora, Catra

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Pre-Canon, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Lonnie keeps her head down but not her mouth shut, Drabble, Urban Legends, Angst, Hurt/Comfort, No editors we die with courage

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English

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Part 2 of Witch's Apprentice AU

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Published: 2022-12-22 Words: 603 Chapters: 1/1

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by genVicron

Summary

Everybody knows Lonnie's stories are true.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The Fright Zone had plenty of horror stories. There was no shortage of nameless, faceless victims to spin tales about The Lieutenant who bumped into Lord Hordak in the halls and hadn't lived to regret the mistake of cussing him out. The naughty children fed to Shadow Weaver's demons to keep her strength up. Soldiers captured by the enemy and tortured for their Princess' amusement.

The older cadets told those stories and laughed just as much as the younger kids shuddered. They were distant, impersonal. The fun and the fear of them was that no one *knew* if they were real or not.

No one laughed at Lonnie's ghost stories.

The older cadets went straight and still when she spoke, scanning the shadows.

The children watched with wide, frightened eyes, not even daring to whisper for fear of bringing down the monster that stalked her past.

What was left of her squad got quiet and sad when some new group of kids asked about them.

Everybody knew Lonnie's stories were true.

Because Lonnie's stories had faces. Lonnie's ghosts had *names.*

Everyone knew about Adora, Shadow Weaver's prized protege. All anyone had to do was mention her to an instructor and they'd be glad to gush and curse about shining, steadfast Adora; who would have been perfect if it hadn't been for Catra, the rowdy magicat troublemaker who led her around by the hand.

The instructors would lament that Catra's mischief had caught up with her, getting Adora killed during training like that. And the cadets would share a look that said they were being lied to.

Because everyone knew that Shadow Weaver had hated Catra more than any of them had ever hated anyone.

Everyone knew that Adora's body had been found in the Black Garnet chamber, but had needed to be burned without the jacket all the stories said she wore, and Catra had never been found at all.

Everyone knew that if Catra had been responsible for Adora's death, she never would have made it out of that room, much less the whole Fright Zone.

Some said she didn't, that the Force Commander had destroyed her right then and there.

But Lonnie knew what happened to the jacket, and what set her apart from anyone else who could guess was that she had the scars to prove it.

Four long marks along her right arm, a hand that had tried to stop her and didn't close right anymore.

A faraway look in her eyes that said she could still see the terror and grief in her squadmate's if she thought about it.

The moral of Lonnie's ghost stories was simple. Keep your head down. Don't be good *or* bad.

Because Shadow Weaver doesn't eat naughty kids.

She eats the good ones, and she makes the bad children *watch.*

Only Rogelio and Kyle ever got to see how Lonnie shook after telling those stories. Only they got to gently take her hands until the scars stopped aching, hold her close and remind her that there's nothing she could have done for their lost leader or the girl Lonnie had let Shadow Weaver trick her into hating for all the wrong reasons.

She was just a kid, too. They had all just been kids.

Only Lonnie knew the thing she always left out.

That once, on the only night she'd ever mustered the nerve to try and investigate, she'd peered into Shadow Weaver's chamber and seen the witch murmuring to her Runestone, a hand pressed flat against it.

She would take it to her grave, that she saw someone reach back from inside.

End Notes

Come say hi at Makuta's Chronicle or genVicron!

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